

film reviews

All in Vain

KARZZZZ

Rating: ★☆☆☆☆

Director: Satish Kaushik

Starring: Himesh

Reshammiya, Urmila

Matondkar

There is no polite way of saying this. Some actors are stars only because of the revenge of the under-class. It's Everyman punching the air with his fist and telling the rest of the world, yes, he too can make it. There is no other earthly reason for Himesh Reshammiya's irresistible rise. Or maybe there is. In *Karzzzz*, for instance, the singing star with a taste for the over-the-top does everything in neon lights. So his transplanted hair is way too hairy, his co-star Urmila Matondkar's red lipstick is much too red,



EXCESS UNLIMITED: Matondkar and Reshammiya

and the sets are far too psychedelic. There's no such thing as subtlety in this shiny remake of Subhash Ghai's remake of *The Reincarnation of Peter Proud*. There are races, balls, gambling, gold jackets and silver dresses. It's like the movies used to be in the bad old days of the eighties when the VCR killed the

movie star, too loud, too long, too incoherent. There are loads of unintentional laughs along the way though, as Reshammiya flies through the air, lavishes attention on Matondkar and pretends to play the guitar. But like the multiple Zs in the title, it's too much of everything, oops, everything.

by Kaveer Banzai

Earnest Attempt

SHOOT ON SIGHT

Rating: ★☆☆☆☆

Director: Jagmohan

Mundhra

Starring: Naseeruddin

Shah, Om Puri

Quick. What's worse than a maker of low budget-low grade movies? A director who used to make them. And who has since discovered cause cinema. So immediately after *Provoked*, Mundhra gives us another movie ripped from the headlines, set in London after 7/7 but just as relevant in India. A Muslim policeman, Naseeruddin Shah, finds his community coming in the way of his duty, as his own nephew, fresh off the boat from Pakistan, is



ALL IN GOOD FAITH: A scene from *Shoot On Sight*

shown falling under the spell of a radical cleric, played as a take-no-prisoners rabble rouser by Om Puri. Shah is out to convince a racist white police officer that all Muslims are not terrorists nor are all terrorists Muslims. But Mundhra spends so much time finding everyone's redeeming qualities that

there is no great drama, despite a Bollywood-style confrontation in a mall. The movie has its heart in the right place. What it needs is a sharper brain. A pleasure though to see the fine Shah shouldering the earnest film with such ease. Is it possible that he is getting better as he gets more grizzled?

—KB

music reviews

Love and Fusion



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TARANA

The piano has been used in film melodies because it adds beauty to the

compositions. You would have the lover singing a song to express his love for his beloved or would witness the anguish of a fruitless relationship. Remember the song in *Kati Patang*, *Pyaar dewana hota hai*, where the notes of the piano capture the romance between the characters. But sadly, today we hardly hear the instrument. Pianist Vandana Kohli has played film melodies on the piano with élan in films like *Payali chun mun chun mun* (*Virasat*); *Kya yahi pyar hai* (*Rocky*); *Kaho na kaho* (*Murder*). She is a filmmaker with a national award to her credit. Her music will enrich your mind.

CONVERGENCE

Two identical brothers who play different instruments—

Murad Ali plays

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the sarangi, while Fateh Ali plays the sitar. Both began under the guidance of their father Ustad Siddique Ahmed Khan Sahib in the true tradition of the Moradabad gharana. In this album, they have collaborated to keep Hindustani classical music as the base and added a variety of styles such as rock, lounge and jazz. And not forgetting the Sufi element, they have paid tribute to Amir Khusrao with his composition *Mohe apne hi rang mein de rang le*. Both have retained their individuality and have not overshadowed each other. The sarangi and sitar converge to relax your senses.

by S. Sahaya Ranj